Ari

DEBUNK MYTHS, DISCOVER TAMIL HERITAGE

The problem

Health myths keep spreading on WhatsApp after fact-checkers have debunked them. The corrections are mostly written in English or Hindi, so Tamil speakers, especially older people, rarely see them. Tamil heritage has a similar gap: the easiest sources are often in English, unsourced, or unreliable.

The solution

Ari is a voice app in Tamil. A user speaks, types, or taps a sample question. Ari replies with a short, checked answer in Tamil text and voice, and shows its source. If it has no checked answer, it says "I don't know" instead of guessing.

How it works

- ★ Gnani Prisma converts the spoken Tamil question to text.
- ★ Ari matches the question against 40 checked entries: 20 health and science myths and 20 Tamil heritage topics.
- ★ Gnani Timbre voices each answer. Voice files are made once, so playback is instant and matches the reviewed text.
- ★ Every entry has a source, and the source is shown with the answer.

What makes it different from a general AI chatbot

- ★ It answers only from entries that have been checked. It doesn't generate an answer that sounds right.
- ★ Every answer comes with a source the user can check or share.
- ★ It refuses unknown and disputed questions, rather than guessing.
- ★ The same question always gives the same checked answer.

Target users

- ★ Primary: adults aged 25 to 50 in Tamil Nadu and the Tamil diaspora who are members of family WhatsApp groups. They receive health or science forwards, and want a sourced reply they can post in the group in Tamil.
- ★ Secondary: parents and grandparents aged 50 and over, who prefer listening to a voice note over reading English text, and who are often the ones forwarding claims.
- ★ Tertiary: Tamil-medium school and college students who want a checkable answer on festivals, literature, and history for homework or exams.

Status and limits

This is a working prototype with 40 topics. It matches questions by keywords and example phrasings.

What we will test next

Whether people use a sourced answer before forwarding a claim.

Which questions Ari misses, using the query log, and adding those phrasings to the entries.